Executive Summary

This document presents the design, configuration, and results of a Joiner-Mover-Leaver (JML) identity lifecycle management workflow built on Okta Workforce Identity for GMGroup Financial, a simulated mid-size financial services company.

Identity lifecycle management is one of the most critical functions in enterprise IAM. When employees join, they need immediate access to the right tools. When they change roles, their access must reflect their new responsibilities. When they leave, every access point must be revoked instantly. Doing this manually is slow, error-prone, and a significant security risk.

This project demonstrates how Okta's group-based access model automates the entire JML lifecycle provisioning and deprovisioning applications automatically based on group membership, with zero manual per-application intervention.

Scenario	Employee	Situation
Joiner	Moyin --Joiner	New hire — Finance Analyst
Mover	Marcus Mover	Transfer — IT to Finance
Leaver	Lena Leaver	Resignation — Finance team

COMPANY OVERVIEW

GMGroup Financial is a simulated mid-size financial services company with two departments :Finance and IT. The following application stack was configured in Okta:

Application	Assigned to	Purpose
Slack	Finance team	Team communication and collaboration
Google Workspace	IT team	Productivity suite and systems administration
GitHub	All staff	Version control — company-wide tool

GROUP BASED ACCESS MODEL

The core architectural decision is that no user is ever manually assigned to an application. Applications are assigned to groups, and users receive access automatically when added to a group. This is the foundation of scalable IAM access driven by role, not individual configuration.

GMGROUP - Finance

Assigned apps: Slack · GitHub

GMGROUP - IT

Assigned apps: Google Workspace · GitHub

GitHub is assigned to both groups as a company-wide tool. All other apps are department-specific, enforcing least privilege.

SCENARIO 1 – JOINER

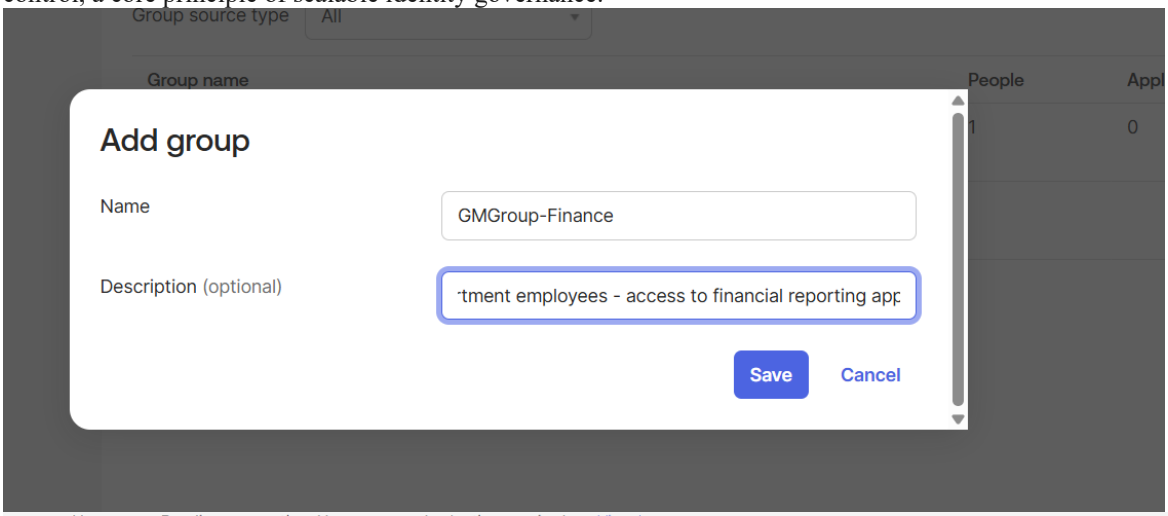
Moyin joiner has accepted an offer as a Finance Analyst. Her start date is Monday. The IT team must ensure her account is created and all Finance apps are provisioned before day one, without manual app-by-app setup.

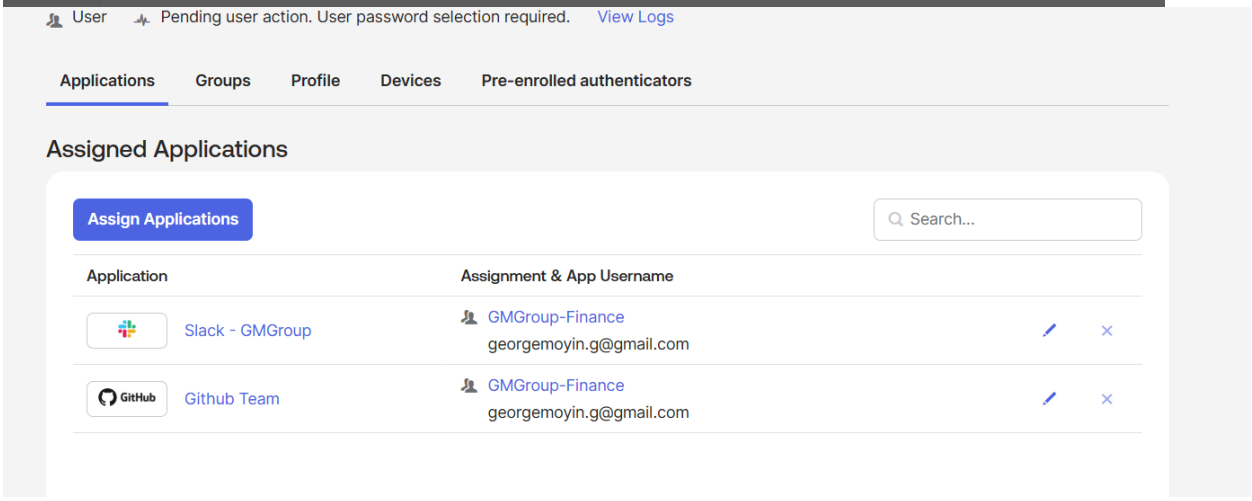
Steps Performed

Field	Joiner – Moyin Joiner
User created	Moyin created in Okta with activation email sent
Group assigned	Added to GMGROUP Finance group
Apps auto-provisioned	Slack and GitHub assigned automatically via group membership, no manual app assignment performed
User notified	Okta activation email sent. Moyin sets her own password
Day 1 access	Moyin logs in to Slack and GitHub immediately on her first day

Key Findings

The moment Ada was added to GMGROUP-Finance, Okta automatically assigned Slack and GitHub to her account. No IT team member manually touched either application. This is automated provisioning via group-based access control, a core principle of scalable identity governance.





SCENARIO 2 – MOVER

Marcus Mover has been in IT for two years and is transferring to Finance, effective immediately. His IT access must be removed and Finance access provisioned on the same day with zero gap and zero overlap.

Befor the move, Marcus's access in IT

Field	Pre-transfer state
Group membership	GMGROUP-IT
Apps assigned	Google Workspace · GitHub
Apps not assigned	Slack (Finance-only tool)

Steps Performed

Field	Mover — Marcus Mover
IT group removed	Marcus removed from GMGGROUP-IT — Google Workspace automatically deprovisioned
Finance group added	Marcus added to GMGROUP-Finance — Slack automatically provisioned
GitHub retained	GitHub remains, it is assigned to both groups
User notified	Marcus informed of access change via email

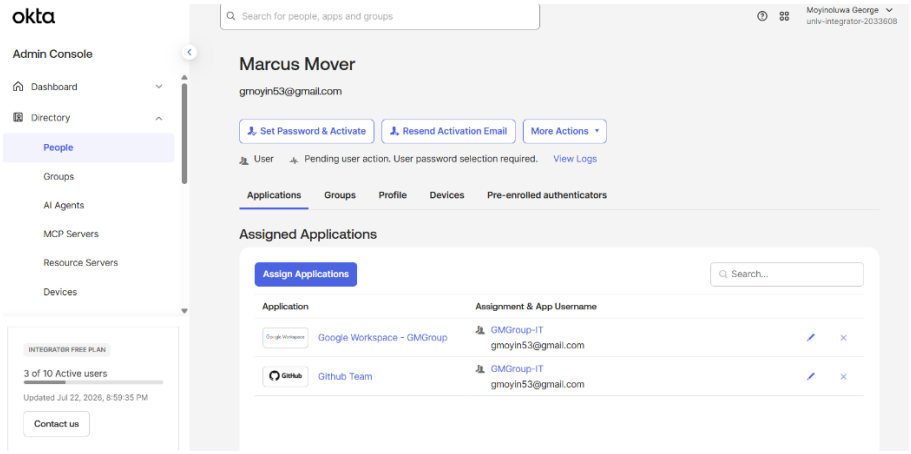
After the move – Marcus's access in Finance

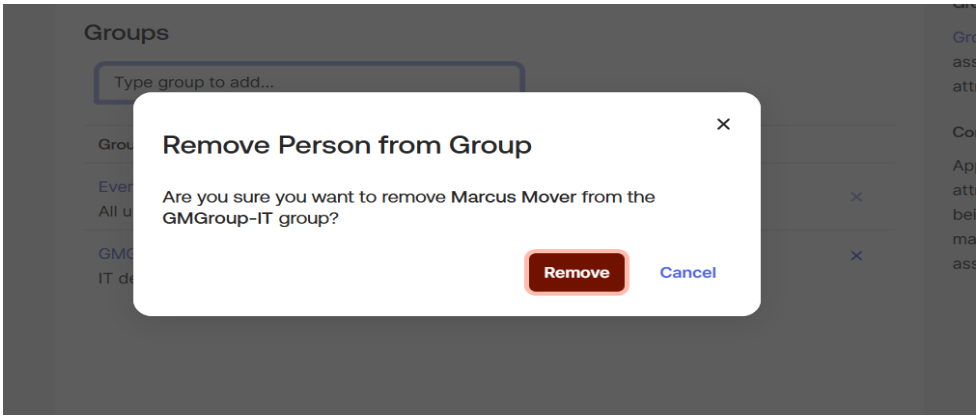
Field	Post-transfer state
Group membership	GMGROUP-Finance
Apps assigned	Slack · GitHub
Apps removed	Google Workspace — deprovisioned automatically on group removal

Key Findings

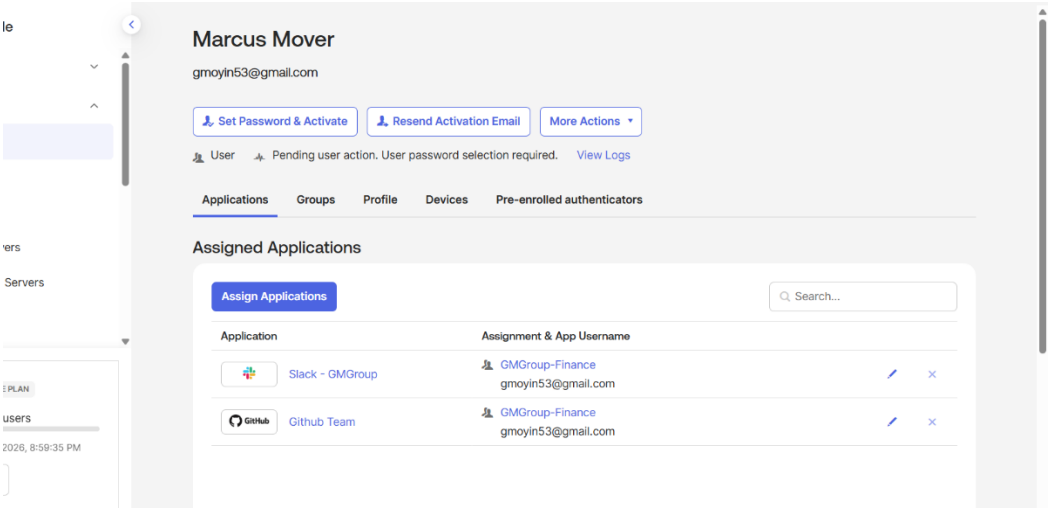
A single group membership change triggered the complete access transition automatically. Google Workspace was removed without IT touching the app. Slack was added without IT assigning it. This is the core value of group-driven IAM: role changes are reflected in access instantly and accurately.

Before the move





After the Move



SCENARIO 3 – Leaver

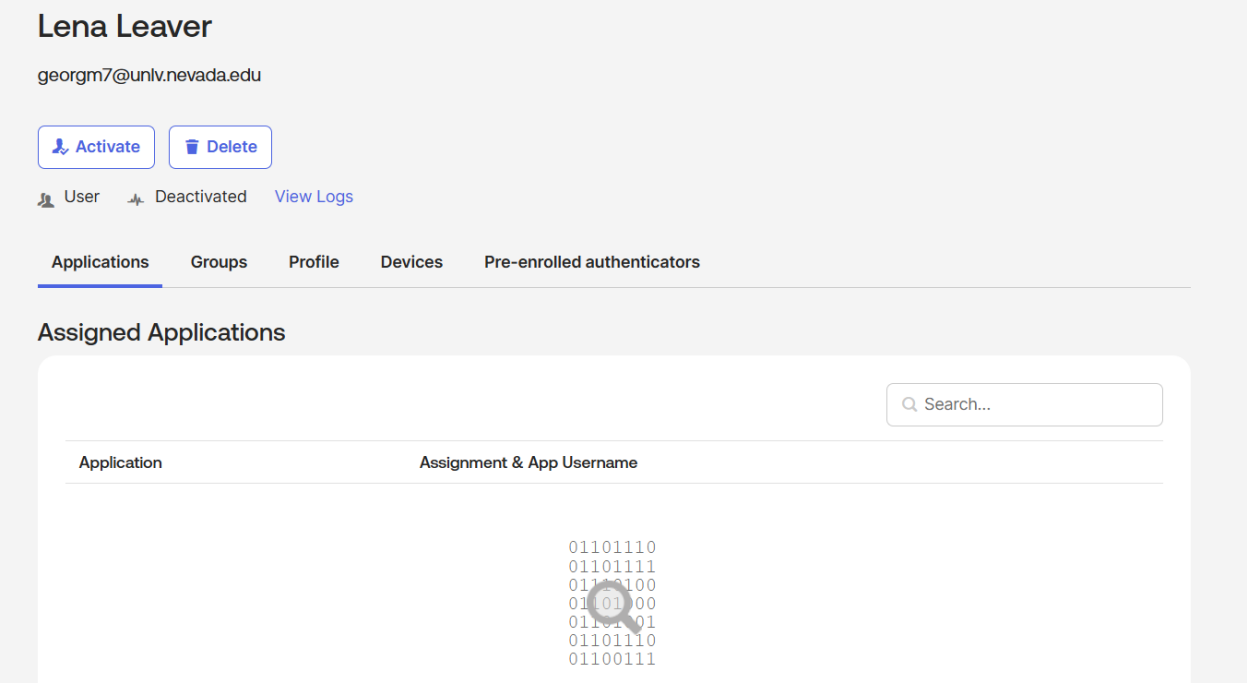
Lena Leaver has submitted her resignation. Her last day is today. Per GMGroupFinancial security policy, all system access must be revoked before she leaves the building. Every minute an ex-employee retains access is a security and compliance risk.

Steps Performed

Field	Leaver — Lena Leaver
Account deactivated	Lena's Okta account set to Deactivated — login disabled immediately across all apps
Sessions cleared	All active Okta sessions terminated — any open browser sessions forcibly logged out
All app access revoked	Slack and GitHub access removed automatically on account deactivation
Account retained 30 days	Deactivated (not deleted) per audit and compliance policy for financial services
Audit log preserved	All activity history retained in Okta logs for forensic and compliance review

Key Findings

Account deactivation in Okta is immediate and comprehensive. All app access is removed and all active sessions terminated in a single action. The account is deactivated rather than deleted because financial services regulations (SOX, PCI-DSS) require audit log preservation. The account is scheduled for deletion after a 30-day retention period



Results and Key learnings

Metric	Outcome
Manual app assignments	Zero, all provisioning and deprovisioning triggered automatically by group changes
Provisioning accuracy	100% , correct apps assigned to correct users in every scenario
Leaver response time	Immediately, all access revoked at the moment of deactivation
Audit trail	Complete, all actions logged in Okta admin audit trail
Least privilege enforced	Yes, Finance users cannot access IT apps and vice versa

What I learned building this

Before building this workflow, I understood JML conceptually. Building it in Okta revealed the operational reality, the power of group-based access is not just in speed, but in the elimination of human error. When access is tied to a group rule rather than a person's decision, there is no possibility of forgetting to remove an app during offboarding or adding the wrong app during onboarding.

The most revealing moment was the Mover scenario. Changing Marcus's department required two group membership changes but triggered four discrete access changes simultaneously and automatically. In a manual process, each of those four changes would require a separate IT ticket and human action. This model scales thousands of employees linearly. The manual alternative does not.

Tools and skills demonstrated

Tool / Platform	How it was used
Okta Workforce Identity	User creation, group management, application assignment, deactivation, session management
Okta Directory---People	User lifecycle: create, activate, deactivate, manage profiles
Okta Groups	Department-based access control — GMGROUP-Finance and GMGROUP-IT
Okta Applications	App integration from Okta catalog — Slack, Google Workspace, GitHub
Okta App Assignments	Group-to-app mapping driving automated provisioning and deprovisioning
Okta Session Management	Force-logout of active sessions during offboarding

IAM concepts applied

- Joiner-Mover-Leaver (JML) identity lifecycle management
- Role-based access control (RBAC) via group membership
- Least privilege — users only access what their role requires
- Automated provisioning and deprovisioning
- Secure offboarding — immediate deactivation and session revocation
- Audit log preservation for compliance and forensic review